

1800–50	1851–1900	1901–20	1921–30	1931–40	1941–50	1951–54	1955–59
1802 Emperor Gia Long founds the Nguyen Dynasty, unifying Vietnam under a single ruler.	1858 Responding to persecution of Catholics, France and Spain invade northern Vietnam. The French stay to create the colony of Cochinchina in 1864.	1905 Vietnamese nationalist Phan Bội Châu writes a history of the loss of Vietnam, in which he advocates independence from colonial rule.	FEBRUARY 1930 Vietnamese troops opposed to French rule mutiny at Yen Bai, but the uprising is swiftly crushed.		JANUARY–JUNE 1951 The Viet Minh launch an offensive against French defenses in the Red River Delta, which is defeated with heavy losses.		JULY 21, 1954 The Geneva Accords divide Vietnam at the 17th parallel, with the Viet Minh controlling the North and the State of Vietnam controlling the South.
1835 Vietnamese Catholics and French Catholic missionaries are persecuted for their participation in a revolt against Emperor Minh Mang.	DECEMBER 1883 A French expeditionary force invading Tonkin (northern Vietnam) defeats Chinese "Black Flag" irregulars at the Battle of Tonkin.	MAY 1916 Emperor Duy Tân is deposed and ruled by the French until he attempts to lead an anticolonial revolt in Vietnam.	OCTOBER 1930 Ho Chi Minh founds the Indochinese Communist Party at a meeting held in the British colony of Hong Kong.	1933 Catholic nationalist Ngô Đình Diem becomes interior minister of Annam under Emperor Bao Dai, but resigns when his proposals for administrative reform are rejected.	MAY 19, 1941 Ho Chi Minh and his colleagues found the Viet Minh movement to fight against the French colonialists and the Japanese occupation of Vietnam.	OCTOBER–NOV 1952 France gains lost an eight-month assault on the Red River area of northern Vietnam in Operation Conquest.	APRIL–MAY 1955 Prime Minister Diem crushes the powerful Binh Xuyen criminal organization in Saigon.
						OCTOBER 1953 Cambodia and Laos are declared fully independent of French rule.	APRIL 28, 1956 The last French soldier leaves Vietnam.
1847 Emperor Tu Duc comes to the Vietnamese throne. Determined to resist foreign influence, he persecutes Vietnamese Catholics.	1885 After killing Vietnamese and Chinese forces, the French establish a protectorate over Tonkin and Annam (central Vietnam), which is codified by the Treaty of Tientsin.	1919 Vietnamese nationalists meet in Paris, including Ho Chi Minh, petition for the right to self-determination at the Versailles Conference. They are ignored.	SEPTEMBER 1940 With France having been defeated by Nazi Germany in Europe, the French allow Japanese troops to use bases in northern Vietnam for their war against China.	MARCH 9, 1945 Japanese troops take over Indochina from the French, declaring Vietnam, Cambodia, and Laos independent. Emperor Bao Dai officially rules Vietnam.	NOVEMBER 20, 1953 Japanese airborne troops establish a base at Dien Bien Phu, near the border of Vietnam and Laos.	MAY 7, 1954 Dien Bien Phu falls to the Viet Minh after eight weeks of fighting—a shattering blow to French morale.	
	1887 French Indochina is created as an administrative union of Tonkin, Annam, Cochinchina, and Cambodia. Laos is added to French Indochina in 1893.			1951 The Geneva Conference opens with the goal of creating peace in Korea and Indochina.	1954 The Geneva Conference opens with the goal of creating peace in Korea and Indochina.	1954 The Geneva Conference opens with the goal of creating peace in Korea and Indochina.	1954 The Geneva Conference opens with the goal of creating peace in Korea and Indochina.
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1800–50

1802

Emperor Gia Long founds the Nguyen Dynasty, unifying Vietnam under a single ruler.

1835

Vietnamese Catholics and French Catholic missionaries are persecuted for their participation in a revolt against Emperor Minh Mang.

1847

Emperor Tu Duc comes to the Vietnamese throne. Determined to resist foreign influence, he persecutes Vietnamese Catholics.